

Eli R. Hooten, Ph.D.

CTO / Developer / Engineer

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

I am a multi-time CTO and technical co-founder with over a decade of startup leadership, having scaled engineering, product, and design teams from 0–30+ and led two companies to eight figures in acquisition. My background spans system architecture, web APIs, open source, fundraising, and business strategy, and I now co-found and build AI-powered software in a high-ownership environment.

EXPERIENCE

CTO / Co-Founder

2025 – Present

Line

- Defined and executed overall technical vision for the product, making key architectural decisions for a scalable, cloud-native platform.
- Built the initial product end-to-end and iterated quickly in response to early customer feedback and product validation.
- Partnered with the founding team on fundraising materials and technical diligence, clearly communicating technical strategy and risks to investors.
- Contributed to company-wide business strategy, aligning product and engineering priorities with long-term growth and defensibility.

Director of Engineering, Codecov

2022 – 2025

Sentry; Remote

- Served as the technical and product leader for Codecov post-acquisition, guiding product strategy and execution within a larger platform organization.
- Devised and led the evolution of Codecov from a code coverage tool into a broader code quality platform, aligning roadmap and architecture with customer needs.
- Scaled Engineering, Design, and Product functions, hiring both individual contributors and managers across multiple product areas to support growth.
- Led team integration and coordinated product launches, ensuring reliable, on-time delivery in a high-growth environment.
- Drove the transition of Codecov from closed source to fully open source, shaping processes, tooling, and community-facing practices.

CTO / Co-Founder

2018 – 2022

Codecov; Remote

- Oversaw all technical operations for a rapidly growing developer tools company, setting long-term architectural direction and platform strategy.
- Led engineering, product, technical support, and solutions engineering teams, building cross-functional alignment around roadmap and execution.
- Owned the technical roadmap and maintained product direction to support multiple initiatives that grew ARR and expanded adoption.
- Scaled the organization from 3 to 30+ people globally, building a distributed engineering culture and leadership layer to support continued growth.
- Ensured production systems were reliable and secure while continuing to ship improvements at startup speed.

CTO / Co-Founder

2012 – 2018

GameWisp, Inc.; Nashville, TN

GameWisp's core technology was acquired by Lightstream in 2019.

- Oversaw technology and product strategy for a subscription and monetization platform used by gaming livestreamers and content creators.
- Grew the team from 1 to 10, hiring and mentoring engineers to deliver new features and maintain a complex production system.
- Designed and developed video upload, encoding, and delivery systems to support high-quality streaming and on-demand content.
- Developed REST and WebSocket APIs that powered the subscriptions platform and were used by a broad ecosystem of external integrations.
- Shipped production-ready code across the stack in a startup environment while contributing to overall company strategic direction.

Research Assistant

2009 – 2014

Department of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science; Vanderbilt University; Nashville, TN

- Developed software design prototypes for academic research using C++/Qt, Ruby on Rails, and JavaScript.
- Performed statistical analysis using R to support research findings and system evaluations.
- Designed and tested unmanned aerial vehicles and balloons for archaeological field use, integrating hardware and software components.
- Supported survey teams in remote Peru with hardware and software setup and troubleshooting.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Computer Science

2014

Vanderbilt University, Nashville, TN

M.Sc., Electrical Engineering

2010

Vanderbilt University, Nashville, TN

SKILLS

CTO leadership · System architecture · Software engineering · Technical leadership · Product management · Team scaling · Business strategy · Fundraising · Web APIs (REST, WebSocket) · Open source development · Statistical analysis · Developer tools · Code quality platforms

PROJECTS

Codecov — Built and evolved large, complex web software at scale, including core components later formalized into the commercial platform.

Subscriptions — Created a fan monetization and rewards platform for live-streamers; underlying GameWisp technology was acquired by Lightstream in 2019.

Video Platform — Developed video functionality for content upload, distribution, and scheduling premium video for creators.

Singularity APIs — Designed and implemented WebSocket and REST APIs for the GameWisp subscriptions platform that were adopted by hundreds of developers.